

Saturday, 3 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

21° 14°

BIRMINGHAM

Drizzle

17° 13°

MANCHESTER

Drizzle

16° 12°

GLASGOW

Overcast

14° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **A suspect has been charged with planning a terror act against Reform UK leader Nigel Farage, following a 'hugely intensive' investigation.**

Counter-terrorism police confirmed the new charge, which follows an earlier accusation against the same individual related to a planned act against Ann Widdecombe. The investigation has been described as complex and ongoing.

CRIME · UK

- 2 **The FA has warned that the verdict against Manchester City has 'significant implications for the integrity of the game'.**

The football club has confirmed it will appeal the guilty verdict, stating the ruling contains 'clear material errors'. This decision has sparked widespread debate about the future of the Premier League.

FOOTBALL · UK

- 3 **The Conservative Party is gearing up to be election-ready ahead of its upcoming party conference.**

The focus will be on the economy and welfare, with Kemi Badenoch reportedly telling her team to prepare for a possible early election. This signals an intensified period of political activity.

POLITICS · UK

- 4 **A man was brutally attacked in his home by crypto thieves who threatened to harm his pregnant wife's baby.**

He was beaten with hammers until he transferred hundreds of thousands of pounds in cryptocurrency. Police are investigating the 'horrific' robbery.

CRIME · UK

- 5 **A British paratrooper has been tragically killed by an explosion in Ukraine, a coroner has ruled.**

L/Cpl George Hooley is the first UK service member to die in Ukraine since Russia's full-scale invasion began in February 2022. The circumstances surrounding his death are being investigated.

CONFLICT · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Chaos and 'Claudiapatra' reigned supreme as Celebrity Traitors kicked off with a bang!**
The new series sees celebrities battling paranoia and confusion in a fight for survival. Expect plenty of twists and turns as the game unfolds.
ON AIR – Who do you think will be the ultimate traitor, and who will be banished first?
TV · TONIGHT
- 2 The second series of Celebrity Traitors has begun with a wild curveball that left viewers stunned.**
The BBC's Noor Nanji reported on a shocking new twist and a traitor's surprising admission. Fans are already buzzing about the drama.
ON AIR – Did you see the big twist coming, or were you as surprised as everyone else?
TV · TONIGHT
- 3 K-pop giants Stray Kids have joined BTS in boycotting the Grammy Awards this year.**
They are the second major act to withdraw from the Grammys over the new best Asian Pop award. This move highlights ongoing discussions about representation in music awards.
ON AIR – Do you think these boycotts will lead to changes in how awards shows recognise global music?
MUSIC · AWARDS
- 4 The wonderful Bill Nighy has picked up the award for best host at the British Podcast Awards!**
The esteemed actor has charmed listeners by becoming an agony uncle in what organisers called an 'irresistibly endearing series'. It's lovely to see him recognised.
ON AIR – What's your favourite podcast, and who would you love to hear as an agony uncle?
AWARDS · THIS WEEK
- 5 An acoustic guitar played by Noel Gallagher at Oasis's iconic 1996 MTV Unplugged gig has sold for a record price.**
The instrument holds a significant place in rock history. It's a testament to the band's enduring legacy and influence.
ON AIR – If you could own any piece of music memorabilia, what would it be?
MUSIC · AUCTION

On the schedule

1 **Manchester City has confirmed it will appeal the guilty verdict against the club, citing 'clear material errors'.**

This decision comes after the FA stated the verdict has 'significant implications for the integrity of the game'. The appeal is set to be a major talking point in football.

ON AIR – Do you think Manchester City's appeal will be successful, and what could this mean for the Premier League?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **England boss Thomas Tuchel says he would 'never rule out' selecting players not in the top flight.**

This statement comes amid speculation about Manchester City's potential relegation. It suggests a broader approach to squad selection for the national team.

ON AIR – If Manchester City were relegated, which of their players do you think could still make the England squad?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **The Super League Grand Final could see a sixth unique winner, with Warrington or Wakefield vying for the trophy.**

Only five clubs have ever lifted the Super League trophy. This year offers a fresh chance for one of these teams to add their name to the history books.

ON AIR – Who are you backing to make history and lift the Super League trophy this year?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

4 **George Russell has tipped Red Bull as the team to beat after the first day of practice at the Bahrain Grand Prix.**

Charles Leclerc also echoed this sentiment, suggesting Red Bull are looking strong early on. It sets up an exciting race weekend in Malaysia.

ON AIR – Do you think Red Bull will dominate the Bahrain Grand Prix, or could another team surprise us?

FORMULA 1 · INTERNATIONAL

5 **Defending champion Robert MacIntyre has made a strong move at the Alfred Dunhill Links Championship.**

He shot a superb second-round 65, placing him just three strokes behind halfway leader Casey Jarvis. It's setting up to be a thrilling weekend of golf.

ON AIR – Can Robert MacIntyre defend his title, or will we see a new champion at the Alfred Dunhill Links?

GOLF · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Slow cookers are flying off the shelves again as energy-conscious shoppers rediscover them.**
They use a fraction of the power of an oven over a day. The downside: the smell of dinner from 9am tests everyone's patience.
- 2 More people are switching their morning scroll for a morning walk, apps suggest.**
Step-counters report a small but steady rise in early-morning activity. The motivation for most? A dog that refuses to wait.
- 3 A poll finds the nation can't agree on the correct way to make a cup of tea.**
Milk first or last remains a genuine source of household tension. The one thing we agree on: someone else should make it.
- 4 Pub quizzes are reporting record team sign-ups, with niche rounds drawing the crowds.**
Music and picture rounds are the great levellers. The cleverest team name still wins more goodwill than the actual answers.
- 5 A poll says most people can't remember the last time they wrote a letter by hand.**
Yet greetings-card sales remain strong — we'll happily sign our name, just not write a full page.
- 6 Reusable coffee cups are finally outnumbering disposables in some city centres.**
Cafés offering a small discount have seen the biggest shift. The catch: most of us still leave the cup at home half the time.
- 7 The crossword and puzzle boom is still going strong, in print and on phones.**
Publishers report a surge in daily puzzlers. The most argued-over answer in households remains anything involving a cryptic clue.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 57% of us admit we've bought THIS purely because it was on offer.

ANSWER: SOMETHING WE HAD ABSOLUTELY NO USE FOR.

Q The thing we're most likely to lie about our skill at is THIS.

ANSWER: PARALLEL PARKING.

TALK TOPIC

- **Scientists say a good laugh is as good for your heart as light exercise.**

Who in your life can make you laugh no matter what — and what's the daftest thing that's set you off?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **The Human Body.** You're about one centimetre taller in the morning than at night, because the soft discs in your spine compress slightly over the course of the day.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Opticians have reported a rise in people asking for glasses with a built-in tiny wiper blade, for 'reading outdoors in the British summer'.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- There's enough water in Lake Superior to cover all of North and South America in a foot of water.
- The microwave was invented by accident when a chocolate bar melted in an engineer's pocket.
- Some cats are allergic to humans.
- The shortest complete sentence in English is 'I am.'
- Norway once knighted a penguin, who holds a military rank in the Norwegian King's Guard.
- A hummingbird's heart can beat over 1,200 times a minute.
- The hashtag symbol is properly called an 'octothorpe'.

On this day

Day 276 of the year, 89 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abd-al-Masih; Christian feast day: Adalgott; Christian feast day: Ambrósio Francisco Ferro; Christian feast day: Blessed Szilárd Bogdánffy. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1968 — Paul Crichton, English footballer and manager
- 1981 — Matt Sparrow, English footballer
- 1973 — Lena Headey, British actress
- 1979 — Josh Klinghoffer, American guitarist, songwriter, and producer
- 1984 — Chris Marquette, American actor
- 1970 — Jimmy Ray, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1988 — ASAP Rocky, American rapper and songwriter
- 1981 — Danny Coid, English footballer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1949 — WERD, the first black-owned radio station in the United States, opens in Atlanta.
- 1962 — Project Mercury: US astronaut Wally Schirra, in Sigma 7, is launched from Cape Canaveral for a six-orbit flight.
- 2008 — The Emergency Economic Stabilization Act of 2008 for the U.S. financial system is signed by President George W. Bush.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1942 — A German V-2 rocket reaches a record 85 km (46 nm) in altitude.
- 1989 — A coup in Panama City is suppressed and 11 participants are executed.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1943 — World War II: German forces murder 92 civilians in Lingiades, Greece.
- 1986 — TASCC, a superconducting cyclotron at the Chalk River Laboratories in Canada, is officially opened.

- 1963 — A violent coup in Honduras begins two decades of military rule.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 277 of the year, 88 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Amun; Christian feast day: Aurea of Paris; Christian feast day: Francis of Assisi Conclusion of Creationtide; Christian feast day: Blessed Francis Xavier Seelos. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1979 — Rachael Leigh Cook, American actress
- 1973 — M. Ward, American singer-songwriter
- 1942 — Christopher Stone, American actor and screenwriter (died 1995)
- 1952 — Jody Stephens, American rock drummer
- 1961 — Jon Secada, Cuban-American singer-songwriter
- 1942 — Bernice Johnson Reagon, American singer-songwriter (died 2024)
- 1959 — Chris Lowe, English singer and keyboard player
- 1949 — Armand Assante, American actor and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1963 — Hurricane Flora kills 6,000 in Cuba and Haiti.
- 1983 — Richard Noble sets a new land speed record of 633.468 miles per hour (1,019.468 km/h) at the Black Rock Desert in Nevada.
- 1958 — The current constitution of France is adopted.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1993 — Tanks bombard the Russian parliament, while demonstrators against President Yeltsin rally outside.
- 1963 — Hurricane Flora kills 6,000 in Cuba and Haiti.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar